

Chapter 5 – Living and Eating in the Rainforest

To experience the Amazon in its purest form, I chose to stay at the remote Inotawa Eco Lodge. From the Puerto Maldonado airport, we first endured more than an hour of bumpy driving to reach a river port. Then, at a tiny dock in “Hell Village”—a name given centuries ago when Spanish soldiers were tormented by heat and insects—we boarded a wooden boat and traveled nearly two hours west along the Tambopata River. The restless water was a deep, earthy brown, the color of fine sediment washed loose by time. As we entered the rainforest, modern society drifted away as well.



The lodge sits quietly on the riverbank, where we spent four days and three nights almost completely disconnected from the outside world. Electricity and Wi-Fi were available only at limited hours; there was no air conditioning or fans, and the showers ran only cold water. Daytime temperatures reached 36°C, paired with 77% humidity that made every breath feel dense and sticky. Clothes soaked through in less than an hour, and we rinsed off in cold water three times a day. At first I doubted I could handle it, but human adaptability is far greater than we imagine.

